

Highlights

- A reusable comparability protocol turns access-layer benchmarks into experiments
- Semantic-equivalence gate: byte-identical responses required before any timing
- Same-SQL control bounds strategy vs machinery; deep fetch 7.15x narrows to 1.68x
- Rankings are configuration-specific and version-sensitive, not a universal order
- Open harness + dual-engine case study (PostgreSQL, MySQL) demonstrate the protocol